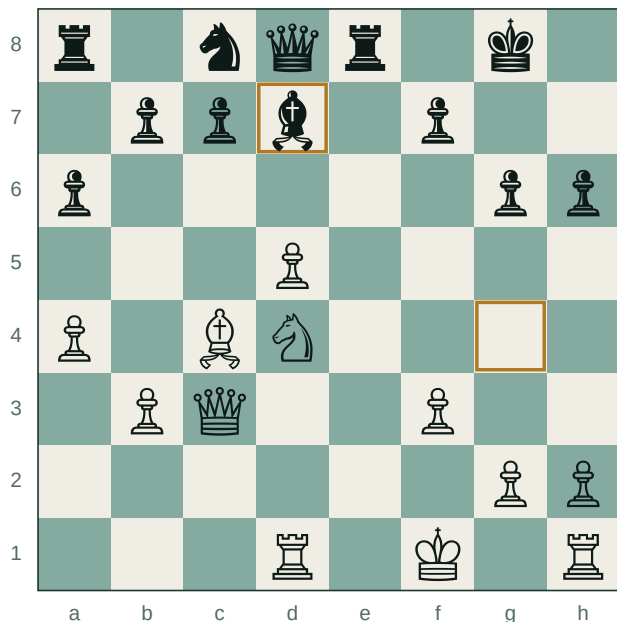


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 21

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 20...Bd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Ne6 Bxe6 22. dxe6 Qxd1+ 23. Kf2 Qd8 24. exf7+

21.Ne6 The knight moves from d4 to e6. Recorded reply: **21...Bxe6**.

22.dxe6 The pawn captures the bishop on e6. The changed line means the rook on d1 attacks the queen on d8. Recorded reply: **22...Qxd1+**.

23.Kf2 The king moves from f1 to f2. The changed line means the rook on h1 attacks the queen on d1. Recorded reply: **23...Qd8**.

24.exf7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f7 it attacks king on g8 and rook on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 27 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -4: the balance goes from +0 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.